

BEYOND THE AI HYPE

Where Does AI Actually
Create Business Value?

Evidence from 1,000 Startup Profiles



PRESENTED BY

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TRADITIONAL
STARTUP

Compete in today's world



AI-ENABLED
STARTUP

Create tomorrow's
advantage



*A cross-industry analysis of AI adoption
and business performance.*

Every Founder Faces the Same Question

THE REALITY



AI is everywhere.



Investors expect it.



Customers ask for it.



Competitors are adopting it.



INVESTMENT

BUSINESS VALUE

BUT AI ISN'T FREE.

Building AI requires:



Engineering talent



Capital



Product redesign



Time to market



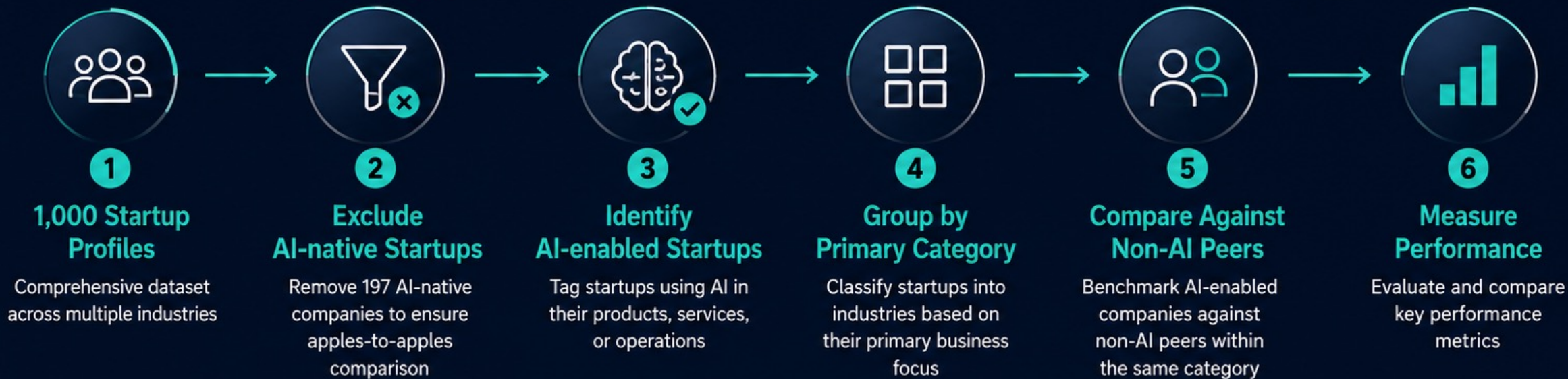
THE REAL QUESTION

Should every founder invest in AI?

Or are some businesses simply better suited for AI than others?

Our Analytical Framework

A rigorous approach to evaluate whether AI drives better business performance



METRICS COMPARED



30-Day Revenue

Total revenue generated in the last 30 days



Monthly Recurring Revenue (MRR)

Predictable monthly revenue from recurring sources



Active Subscriptions

Number of paying active customers



Revenue per Subscription

Average revenue generated per active subscription



By comparing companies within the same industry, we isolate whether AI adoption is associated with **stronger business performance** – not just industry differences.

AI Is Becoming a Business Capability, Not Just an Industry

AI adoption is already widespread across non-AI startups.



1,000

Startup Profiles

Analyzed across multiple industries



803

Non-AI Startups Evaluated

After excluding AI-native startups

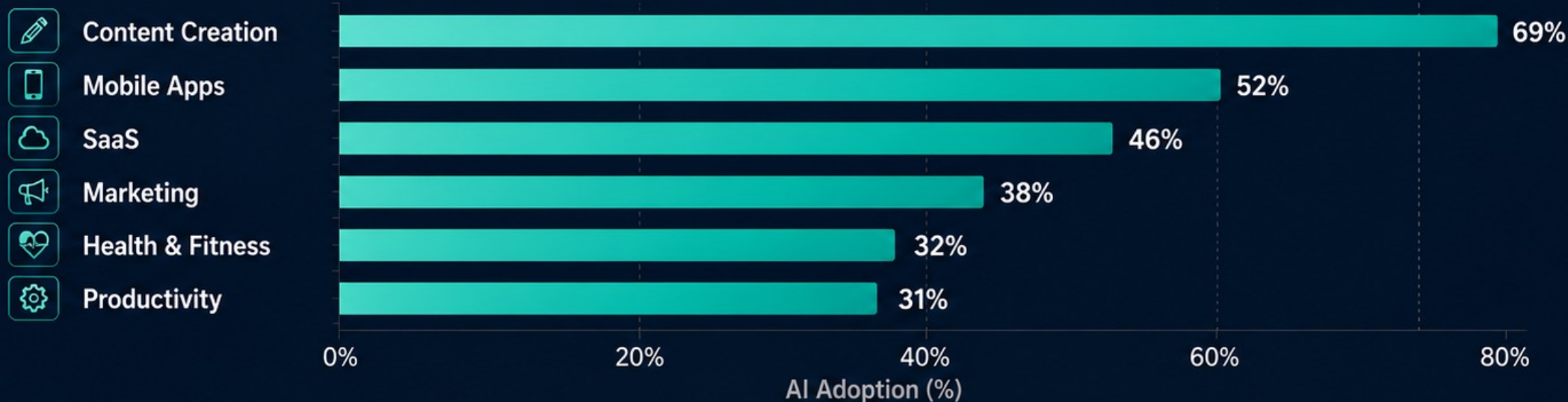


27%

Already AI-enabled

Among non-AI startups

WHERE IS AI BEING ADOPTED?



KEY INSIGHT

AI has already moved beyond AI-native companies.

More than **one in four startups** from non-AI industries have integrated AI into their products or services.

AI Creates the Strongest Business Impact

in Four Industries

Revenue lift of AI-enabled startups vs. non-AI peers within the same industry



EDUCATION

REVENUE LIFT

+285%

AI enables personalized learning experiences, adaptive content, and intelligent tutoring, which appear to translate into stronger business performance.



CONTENT CREATION

REVENUE LIFT

+219%

AI accelerates content generation and creative workflows, creating a clear and measurable business advantage.



HEALTH & FITNESS

REVENUE LIFT

+228%

AI-powered recommendations and personalized coaching appear to improve customer value and business outcomes.



MOBILE APPS

REVENUE LIFT

+88%

AI enhances user engagement and product experience, contributing to stronger revenue performance.



Across these industries, AI appears to create value by improving **personalization, automation, and customer experience** — not merely by adding technology.



Note: Revenue Lift (%) compares the average 30-day revenue of AI-enabled startups with their non-AI peers within the same primary category.

Revenue Lift (%) = $\frac{(\text{Average 30-day Revenue (AI-enabled)} - \text{Average 30-day Revenue (Non-AI)})}{\text{Average 30-day Revenue (Non-AI)}} \times 100$

AI Doesn't Improve Performance Everywhere

Comparing categories within the same industry shows that AI impact depends on the **nature of the business** and how **revenue is generated**



Marketing

-84%

AI alone does not appear to translate into higher revenue. Distribution and brand positioning may still dominate performance.



Dev Tools

-77%

Technical capability alone is not enough to create business differentiation.



SaaS

-72%

Traditional SaaS companies continue to perform strongly even without AI capabilities.



Analytics

-64%

AI does not automatically improve outcomes in data-driven products.



E-commerce

-95%

AI features alone are not enough to drive stronger revenue in a highly competitive space.



The data suggests that AI is most valuable when it **strengthens the core customer experience** — not when it is simply added as another feature.

Why Does AI Work in Some Industries and Not in Others?

The pattern is clear.



PERSONALIZATION

AI tailors experiences to individual users, creating more value and stronger engagement.



AUTOMATION

AI reduces manual effort and operational friction, improving efficiency and margins.



PREDICTION

AI improves outcomes through better forecasts, insights, and decision making.



RECOMMENDATION

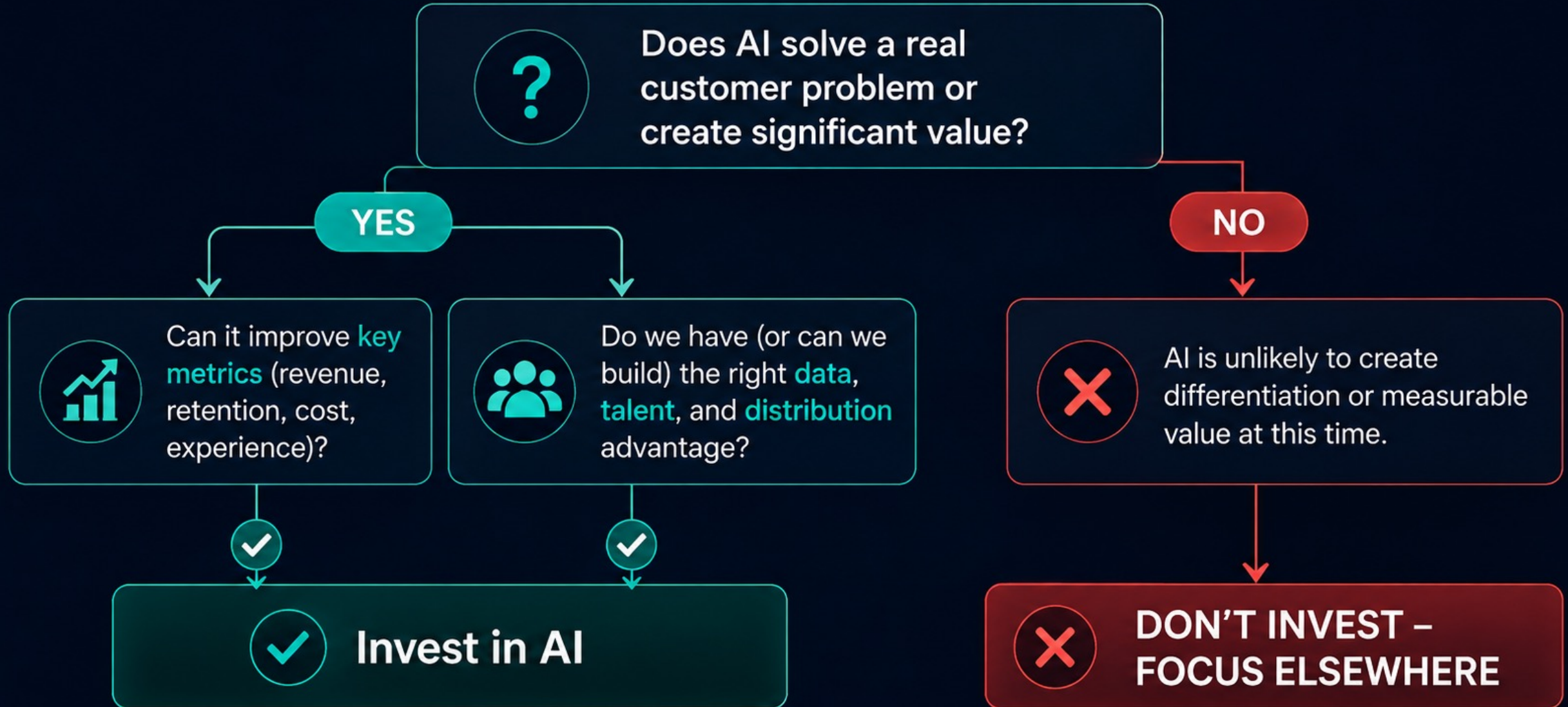
AI-powered suggestions and curation increase discoverability and drive conversions.



Industries where these levers directly enhance the **core customer experience** see the strongest business impact from AI.

Founder Decision Framework

Should You Invest in AI?



Five Strategic Insights for Founders

1



AI is now a **cross-industry capability**.

It's being adopted across every major startup category.

2



Nearly **one in four** non-AI startups

have already integrated AI into their business.

3



AI creates the **strongest impact** in industries

centered around content, education, personalization, and consumer experiences.

4



In industries like **SaaS, Marketing, and Dev Tools**,

AI does not automatically lead to better performance.

5



The best founders won't ask "**Should we build AI?**"

They'll ask "Where will AI create **measurable value** for our customers?"

“

**Don't ask whether
to build AI.**

**Ask where AI creates
measurable business value.**



RIGHT PROBLEM.



RIGHT INDUSTRY.



REAL IMPACT.